

Research Integrity Policy

1. Commitment to Research Integrity

Westbrook University upholds the highest standards of integrity in research conducted by its students, faculty, and staff. Research integrity encompasses honest reporting, transparent methodology, proper attribution, and ethical treatment of human and animal subjects.

2. Research Misconduct Defined

- Fabrication: Making up data or results and recording or reporting them
- Falsification: Manipulating materials, equipment, or processes to alter results
- Plagiarism: Misappropriating another researcher's ideas, data, or writings
- Failure to disclose conflicts of interest in funded research
- Violation of Institutional Review Board (IRB) protocols for human subjects research

3. Reporting Research Misconduct

Suspected research misconduct should be reported to the Office of Research Integrity (ORI). Reports may be submitted anonymously. The ORI will conduct a preliminary inquiry within 30 days to determine whether a full investigation is warranted.